EXCEL BASICS TEXTBOOK 2019
Complete Beginner to Intermediate Guide for Excel 2019 on Windows

Excel Basics Editorial Team - 2019 Edition v2.3
Published 2019 for Microsoft Excel 2019 / Office 365 (Windows Desktop)
140 Pages | ISBN 978-981-18-0244-7

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CHAPTER 1 - WHAT IS EXCEL AND WHERE TO START

1.1 What you see on screen

When you open Excel 2019 you see a blank Workbook with 1 Worksheet called Sheet1. Across the top is the Ribbon with tabs: File, Home, Insert, Page Layout, Formulas, Data, Review, View.

A cell is the box where a row and column meet, for example B3 is column B, row 3. The Name Box on the top-left shows the cell address. The Formula Bar shows what is inside the cell.

1.2 Create your first file

1. Click Blank workbook.
2. Click File > Save As > This PC. Type file name: MyFirstStock.xlsx
3. In cell A1 type: Item. In B1 type: Qty. In C1 type: Price.

4. Press Ctrl + S to save.

Tip for 2019: AutoSave is only for OneDrive files. If you work offline, press Ctrl + S often.

CHAPTER 4 - BASIC FORMULAS (EXTRACT)

4.3 SUM and AVERAGE
=SUM(B2:B10) adds all numbers from B2 to B10.
=AVERAGE(C2:C10) gives average price.
=COUNT(B2:B10) counts how many cells have numbers.
=COUNTA(A2:A10) counts non-empty cells.

4.5 IF function
=IF(D2>20,"Order More","OK")
If value in D2 is more than 20, show Order More, otherwise show OK.
Nested IF:
=IF(B2=0,"Out of Stock",IF(B2<10,"Low","Enough"))

Practice: Make a small table:
A2 Rice 5kg, B2 8, C2 12.50, D2 =B2*C2. Result is 100.00. Format D2 as Currency > SGD.

CHAPTER 7 - VLOOKUP, HLOOKUP AND XLOOKUP INTRODUCTION (PAGES 96-112)

7.1 Why VLOOKUP is useful
Imagine you have two lists. List 1 is daily usage. List 2 is the master price list. Instead of typing the price again and again, you ask Excel to LOOK UP the price.

Syntax in Excel 2019:
=VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])

lookup_value = what you want to find, e.g. A2 containing code "CHX01"
table_array = where the master list is, e.g. $F$2:$G$50
col_index_num = which column has the answer, e.g. 2 for price
range_lookup = FALSE for exact match, TRUE for approximate match. For stock and price, always use FALSE.

7.2 Full worked example
Master Price in F1:G5:
F1 Code | G1 Unit Price
F2 CHX01 | G2 4.50
F3 RCE01 | G3 12.50
F4 OIL02 | G4 8.90

F5 CHL03 | G5 3.20

Daily table in A1:C10:
A1 Code | B1 Qty Used | C1 Price (formula)
In C2 type:
=VLOOKUP(A2,$F$2:$G$5,2,FALSE)
Copy down to C10. If code is missing, you will see #N/A.

7.3 How to handle #N/A
Wrap with IFERROR:
=IFERROR(VLOOKUP(A2,$F$2:$G$5,2,FALSE),"Check Code")
This shows Check Code instead of error.

7.4 HLOOKUP in one page
HLOOKUP works across a row instead of down a column:
=HLOOKUP("Price",A1:E2,2,FALSE)
In 2019 most users need VLOOKUP only. HLOOKUP is kept for horizontal price sheets.

7.5 Common VLOOKUP mistakes
1. Extra spaces: "CHX01 " is not same as "CHX01". Use =TRIM(A2).
2. Numbers stored as text. Green triangle on corner means text. Click ! > Convert to Number.
3. Forgot $ signs. When you copy down, $F$2:$G$5 stays fixed. Without $, it shifts and gives wrong result.
4. Wrong column number. Count from first column of your table_array, not from column A.

7.6 Exercise 7A
Build a 20-row sheet. Column A: Item Code, Column B: Qty, Column C: VLOOKUP price, Column D: =B2*C2 for total. At bottom: =SUM(D2:D21) for day total.

CHAPTER 8 - PIVOTTABLES FOR DAILY STOCK AND SALES SUMMARY (PAGES 113-132)

8.1 What is a PivotTable
A PivotTable lets you summarise hundreds of rows in 30 seconds. No formulas needed after setup. Example: from 200 rows of daily usage, get total qty by Item, by Week, by Supplier.

8.2 Prepare your data correctly (very important)
Before creating a PivotTable, your data must be clean:
1. Row 1 must be headers with no empty cells: Date | Item | Category | Qty | Unit Price | Total
2. No blank rows inside. No merged cells.
3. Dates must be real dates, not text like "Monday".

4. Convert to Table: Click any cell > Insert > Table > My table has headers.

Sample data rows 2-6:
03/09/2026 | Chicken Whole | Meat | 5 | 9.80 | 49.00
03/09/2026 | Rice 5kg | Dry | 2 | 12.50 | 25.00
04/09/2026 | Chicken Whole | Meat | 6 | 9.80 | 58.80
04/09/2026 | Cooking Oil 2L | Dry | 1 | 8.90 | 8.90
04/09/2026 | Chilli Padi | Veg | 3 | 3.20 | 9.60

8.3 Create your first PivotTable step-by-step (Excel 2019 Windows)
1. Click any cell inside your table.
2. Go to Insert > PivotTable > From Table/Range.
3. Choose New Worksheet > OK. You see an empty PivotTable and Field List on right.
4. In Field List, drag:
   Item to ROWS
   Qty to VALUES (it becomes Sum of Qty)
   Category to FILTERS
   Date to COLUMNS (group by month if needed)
5. To show money total: Drag Total to VALUES. Right-click any value > Number Format > Currency > SGD > 2 decimals.

You now have: each Item with total Qty and total spent.

8.4 Group by week / month
Right-click any Date in PivotTable > Group > Select Months + Days > 7 Days for weekly view. This is useful for weekly stock order.

8.5 Refresh when you add new rows
If your Table grows, click inside PivotTable > Analyze > Refresh > Refresh All. If you used Insert > Table, new rows are included automatically.

8.6 Two useful layouts for stall stock sheet
Layout A - Order Check:
ROWS: Item, COLUMNS: (none), VALUES: Sum of Qty, FILTERS: Category = Dry
Sort Sum of Qty smallest to largest to see what ran out.

Layout B - Monthly Spend:
ROWS: Category, COLUMNS: Months, VALUES: Sum of Total
Gives Meat vs Dry vs Veg spend per month.

8.7 PivotChart in 2 clicks
Click inside PivotTable > Analyze > PivotChart > Column Chart > OK. Right-click Chart > Move Chart > New Sheet.

8.8 Exercise 8A - 7-day stock summary
Use the practice file Stock7Days.xlsx (50 rows). Tasks:
1. Create PivotTable showing Sum of Qty by Item.

2. Add Category as Slicer: Insert > Slicer > Category. Use slicer buttons to filter.
3. Change Value Field Settings to show Average instead of Sum. Observe difference. Change back to Sum.

CHAPTER 9 - CHARTS AND PRACTICE EXERCISES (EXTRACT)

9.1 Quick chart
Select A1:B10 with Item and Qty. Insert > Recommended Charts > Clustered Column > OK. Add Chart Title: Weekly Usage. Right-click axis > Format Axis > Number.

9.2 Print one page
Page Layout > Orientation > Landscape. Fit Sheet on One Page. File > Print > Preview.

Final Practice Set (Page 138):
1. Create workbook StallStock2019.xlsx with 3 sheets: DailyUse, PriceList, Summary.
2. In DailyUse, use VLOOKUP to pull price from PriceList.
3. Build PivotTable in Summary showing total qty and total cost by Item.
4. Save and backup to USB.

Appendix: Keyboard Shortcuts for Excel 2019
Ctrl + C / Ctrl + V / Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + S / Ctrl + F (Find) / Ctrl + H (Replace)
Ctrl + Arrow keys to jump to end of data. Alt + = for AutoSum. F4 to repeat or lock $ reference.

End of Ebook - Page 140.

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